Solar Energy

Chapter 7 Unit 2 Guided Notes · Grade 4 Using Natural Resources for Energy

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

BIG QUESTION **How do people use sunlight as a source of energy?**

KEY WORDS

solar power — the use of _____ to meet energy needs.

solar cell — a device that converts _____ to electricity.

ELECTRICITY PATHWAY

SUNLIGHT

↓

STRIKES A SOLAR CELL

↓

MAKES ELECTRICITY

OTHER WAYS TO USE SUNLIGHT

Sunlight can also heat water and cook food.

WAY TO USE SUNLIGHT	HOW IT WORKS
solar panel	_____
solar oven	_____
solar water heater	_____

CHECK YOUR THINKING

What does a solar cell do?

_____

Benefits and Limitations

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

BENEFITS AND LIMITATIONS

BENEFIT	LIMITATION
renewable (sun keeps shining)	_____
no fuel is burned	_____
depends on sunlight (not at night)	_____
costs money to install	_____

AVAILABLE LIGHT

Different places get different amounts of sunlight at different times. Solar power depends on the light that is available.

On a cloudy day, a solar panel makes _____ electricity.

At night, there is _____ sunlight.

CHECK YOUR THINKING

Why is solar called renewable but not always available?

CONNECT *Chapter 7 connection: sunlight is free and renewable, but it depends on location, weather, and time of day.*